



CHAPTER 61.

An Act to obtain contributions from persons in the event of their liability for damage or loss from Explosions of, or other accidents in connection with, Munitions being assumed by His Majesty's Government. A.D. 1916.

[22nd December 1916.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

1.—(1) If provision is made by any scheme framed by, or on the authority of, the Minister of Munitions for the assumption by His Majesty's Government of any of the liabilities of persons manufacturing or dealing with munitions to which this Act applies for damage or loss attributable to the explosion of munitions, contributions shall be paid by the persons whose liability is assumed at such times and of such amounts as may be fixed by, or in accordance with the provisions of, the scheme, and any such contributions may be recovered by or on behalf of His Majesty, either by means of deductions from any sums payable by or on behalf of His Majesty's Government to the persons liable to pay the contributions or from those persons summarily as a civil debt.

Contribution by persons carrying on munition works in respect of liability for damage caused by explosion.

(2) The Minister of Munitions shall appoint an advisory committee consisting wholly or in part of persons having special knowledge of insurance for the purpose of advising him with respect to the contributions under any such scheme, and may, if he thinks fit, delegate the fixing of the amounts of the contributions to that committee.

(3) If under any such scheme different rates of contribution are fixed for different classes of persons or different classes of liability or risk, any person who is at the time of the passing of this Act manufacturing or dealing with munitions to which this Act applies may, within any time fixed by the scheme, object to any contributions demanded from him on the ground that the rate applicable in his case should be the rate of some class other

[CH. 61.] *Munitions (Liability for Explosions)* [6 & 7 GEO. 5.]
Act, 1916.

A.D. 1916. --- than that demanded ; and in that case the question as to the class of rate payable by that person shall, in default of agreement, be determined by a referee to be appointed by the advisory committee appointed under this Act, or, if the parties and the committee so agree, shall be determined by the committee.

(4) The munitions to which this Act applies are any ammunition or mines for naval or military purposes and any component part of any such ammunition or mines and any explosives for any such ammunition or mines ; and the expression "dealing with munitions" includes the handling and storage of munitions.

(5) This Act shall apply to the accidental escape or release of asphyxiating or deleterious gases, which have been, or are being, produced for use in naval or military operations, as it applies to explosions of munitions.

Short title.

2. This Act may be cited as the Munitions (Liability for Explosions) Act, 1916.

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FOR

FREDERICK ATTERBURY, Esq., C.B., the King's Printer of Acts of Parliament.